

Najam Khan

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Senior IT Project/Program Manager | Senior IT Business Consultant

Certified CompTIA Security+ | Scrum Master | PMI®-PMP Certified | ISACA COBIT-5 | ITSM-ITIL V3

Professional Summary:

Dynamic and results-oriented Senior IT Project and Program Manager with over 15 years of extensive experience leading complex IT initiatives across various industries, including manufacturing, banking, and healthcare. A certified PMI-PMP professional with a strong record in strategic project planning, execution, and delivery, focusing on IT infrastructure modernization and strengthening organizational cybersecurity. Skilled IT Business Consultant with expertise in portfolio planning and prioritization to align IT initiatives with business objectives. Proficient in applying both Waterfall and Agile methodologies to lead cross-functional teams and manage end-to-end project cycles, adapting effectively to project needs to improve efficiency and effectiveness. Possesses deep knowledge of IT governance, risk management, and compliance standards, ensuring all projects adhere to industry regulations. Dedicated to building solid stakeholder relationships and enhancing service delivery through clear communication and collaboration, driven by a passion for innovation and a continuous pursuit of technological improvement.

Skills & Competencies:

- **Project, Program and Portfolio Management, 15+ years:** Certified Project Manager (PMI-PMP®) and Scrum Master with deep expertise in waterfall, hybrid, and agile methodologies, as well as budgeting, lifecycle costing, and scheduling.
 - Proven track record in successfully delivering complex, business-critical projects, including system upgrades and cloud service migrations, while consistently surpassing targets and enhancing team performance.
 - Proficient in managing multiple complex projects simultaneously, employing methodologies such as Agile, Waterfall, and hybrid approaches to drive efficiency and meet deadlines
 - Strong ability to cultivate relationships with key stakeholders, facilitating effective communication and collaboration across diverse teams and levels of management.
 - Proficient in overseeing the entire product lifecycle (PLC), from concept and development to launch and post-release optimization, ensuring alignment with business goals and market needs. Skilled at cross-functional collaboration, process improvement, and driving successful product outcomes.
 - Experienced in developing and managing program budgets, monitoring financial performance, and optimizing resource allocation to maximize ROI.
 - Offers extensive experience with project management and collaboration tools, such as Microsoft Project Plan, Clarity PPM, ServiceNow SPM, JIRA, Azure DevOps Server (TFS), Smartsheet, SharePoint, and Confluence.
- **Cybersecurity & Risk Management, 12 Years:** Extensive knowledge of threat intelligence, vulnerability management, and incident response, as well as establishing and overseeing security controls to mitigate security risks, and establishing IT policies, standards, and procedures to ensure data integrity, security, and efficiency. **Deft in conducting Cybersecurity Risk Assessment against ISO/IEC 27001, NIST CSF & SOC2.**
- **IT Business Consultant with 8 years of experience:** Experienced IT Business Consultant with a proven track record in managing the planning, execution, and governance of IT projects and product portfolios. Ensures all initiatives align with strategic business goals, consistently delivering measurable value and optimizing resource allocation and funding to achieve successful results. Proficient in gathering requirements, analyzing processes, and aligning IT initiatives with organizational objectives. Skilled in SWOT analysis, user story development, and process mapping.
- **IT Infrastructure & Cloud Computing, 18+/8+ Years:** Expert in managing IT infrastructure design, implementation, and maintenance, including automated server patch management, securing network infrastructure, SAN/NAS, data center management, and operational technology (OT). Experienced in developing cloud strategy and selecting platforms such as AWS-IaaS, Azure Services (e.g., Entra ID, Intune, Azure SQL Database, Backup & Site Recovery, VMs, App Service (PaaS), Monitor, Storage, DevOps, and Azure Migrate), optimizing resource allocation and cost management.

- **Framework & Standards, 18 Years:** Adept in managing assessment projects and programs aligned with NIST CSF, ISO/IEC 27001, SOC 2, ISO/IEC 62443, COBIT5, ISO/IEC 22301, ISO/IEC 20000, ISO 20022, PCI, HIPAA, HITRUST, and CMMI Level 3.
- **Security Tools, 10 Years:** Microsoft Defender Suite, Defender for Endpoint, Intune, Microsoft Purview, SIEM (Google Chronicle, Splunk), IAM (Microsoft Entra ID, OKTA, AUTH0), PAM, VMWare (ESXi 8.0), TCP/IP (NAC), Nessus, CrowdStrike, Autopsy, DLP/IPS, NGFW, Terraform.

• IT Operations Management, 18 Years	• Risk Assessment & Management, 10 Years
• IT Service Management, 15 Years	• Governance, Risk & Compliance, 10 Years
• Merger, Acquisition, and Divestiture, 6 Years	• Disaster Recovery Planning/BCP, 12 Years
• ERP/Application Transition/ Implementation, 8 Years	• Change Management, 15 Years
• Incident / Problem Management, 15 Years	• Policy Development and Management, 10 Years
• Training and Development, 10 Years	• Performance Management, 15 Years
• Contract/Vendor Management, 15 Years	• IT Strategy & Planning, 10 Years

Education:

- **University of Phoenix, San Jose Campus, CA, USA (2001)**
M.Sc. Computer Information Technology (GPA 3.9/4.0)
- **Southern Illinois University, Carbondale, IL, USA (1998)**
BSc. Management Information Systems (GPA 3.2/4.0)

Training Certifications:

- Certified CompTIA Security+ (2025)
- Certified PSM 1 Scrum Master (2021)
- Certified COBIT 5 Foundation (2017)
- Certified PMI® PMBOK (PMP) (2010 & 2016)
- Certified Microsoft Project Management Professional (2012)
- Certified EPI - Data Centre Professional (2012)
- Certified ITIL Foundation v3 (2011)

Professional Experience:

08/2024 – Present

Cybersecurity Project Manager (M&A), Humana, (Contract Role/Remote)

- Successfully led complex, high-impact fixed-cost projects in enterprise environments from conception to successful delivery, ensuring significant business value and operational excellence. This includes, but is not limited to, managing post-merger issues and opportunities related to IT infrastructure, Cloud, applications, endpoint protection, IAM/PAM, Telecom, BC/DR, incident management, regulatory compliance requirements, and improving overall cybersecurity posture and target state against Minimum Necessary Requirements based on HIPAA, HITRUST, NIST CSF, MASS 201 CMR 17.00.
 - Collaborated successfully with a cross-functional team to address security gaps, particularly those related to the acquiring company's Minimum Necessary Requirements, based on standards like HIPAA, HITRUST, Massachusetts 201 CMR 17.00, and NIST CSF.
 - Led the development and implementation of project management plans for M&A Issues and Opportunities (IOPs), working with teams to address and close identified gaps.
 - Directed implementation of advanced security measures and recommended controls based on the identified security gaps of the acquired company.

10/2023 – 07/2024

Sr. IT Program/Project Manager, Cybersecurity/Infrastructure at 3M Inc. (Remote/Contract role)

Key Responsibilities:

- **Directed and managed end-to-end Seven Cybersecurity Posture Improvement Projects aligned with NIST Cybersecurity and Cybersecurity Maturity Model Certification Frameworks, compliance objectives**
 - Developed and maintained project plans, timelines, and budgets across multiple workstreams
 - Coordinated cross-functional teams and managed vendor partnerships
 - Identified and mitigated project risks and resolved issues proactively.
 - Facilitated communication between technical teams and business stakeholders
 - Ensure projects support enterprise cybersecurity goals and CMMC
 - Developed and maintained comprehensive project documentation, including stakeholder engagement plan, schedule/planning (WBS), risk assessments (RAID), RACI Matrix,
 - Crafted weekly project status reporting, including milestones, achievements, WIP, budgeting, and forecasting
 - Utilized Microsoft Office Suite – SharePoint for team collaboration, MS Project for project planning, budgeting, and resource management; and Azure DevOps to track progress and identify issues and roadblocks for each PBI.

Projects & Achievements:

- **Led a key project as part of the broader NIST Cybersecurity Maturity Assessment and Controls Testing Program**, overseeing 3M's cybersecurity maturity assessment and testing of 110 controls against industry standards and best practices. Delivered critical deliverables that effectively mitigated identified risks and vulnerabilities across technical and operational components. Some of the key activities of the program included:
 - Conducted testing of selected controls across all five NIST CSF Core functions: Detect, Protect, Identify, Respond, & Recover.
 - Built and maintained executive-level dashboards using Azure DevOps (TFS), Power BI, and Jira Kanban Board to present status on identified gaps & issues, project estimates, and compliance progress, while coordinating cross-functional teams of 15 to 20 members, utilizing Azure DevOps (TFS) to monitor progress, resolve roadblocks, and ensure timely delivery.
- **Oversaw transition of 3M's legacy Security Incident Event Management (SIEM) system to AI-enabled Splunk:** Effectively managed project plan, vendor, and SMEs to configure 32 data inputs to leverage Splunk's data ingestion capabilities to gain valuable AI insights into 3M's security posture, IT operations, and business performance
- **Led 3M's Third-Party Risk Management (TPRM) Project:** Automated and streamlined vendor offboarding process and risk assessment of legal vendors, and updated policies, procedures, and guidelines.
- **Addressed NIST CSF (ID-AM) findings on 3M's asset management governance** by enhancing the ServiceNow IT Asset Management module and leveraging the Trellix Change Control solution to cover all business-critical assets and MS Visio for redesign the process workflows.
- **Significantly enhanced incident management and disaster recovery (DR) processes** by aligning the disaster recovery strategy with the NIST Cybersecurity Framework, with a clear focus on the recovery function and enabling Azure Site Recovery (DRaaS).

04/2023 – 10/2023

Sr. IT Infrastructure Project Manager, Excelerate Energy (Full-time - Onset Tech), The Woodlands/Houston, TX

Responsibilities:

- Successfully led multiple IT infrastructure improvement projects, coordinating resources across IT and within business operating units.
- Ensured project activities were aligned to deliver identified technology strategies and business goals/objectives while meeting quality, scheduling, budget, and IT standard requirements.
- Regularly carried out project workshops, project sponsors, and project status meetings with relevant stakeholders.

Projects & Achievements:

- **Oversaw upgrade and integration of EE OneOcean Document Management Systems and Legal Contract Management System:** Successfully integrated both SaaS solutions with existing HR & ERP systems, enabling seamless data flow and improving data accuracy. The implementation involved integrating Azure Single Sign-On (SSO) to enhance the security and user experience within Identity and Access Management (IAM) and Privileged Access Management (PAM) frameworks. This integration ensures that user authentication is centralized, streamlined, and secure, reducing the risk of unauthorized access and simplifying credential management across the organization.
- **Successfully refreshed offshore network components and upgraded desktop hardware and software, enhancing system performance and operational efficiency:**
 - Upgraded the firewalls of six vessels to Cisco NGFW and created and defined security policies, including access controls, user identity settings, application controls, and threat prevention features.
 - Successfully led the upgrade of corporate Windows 7 desktops to Windows 10 while implementing Office 365 and Virtual Desktop Infrastructure (VDI), which enhanced productivity and collaboration for 440 users across the offshore vessels, alongside a 75% hardware refresh to support new system requirements.
- **Revamped EE offshore data centers and enhanced IT/OT cybersecurity by implementing SD-WAN:** Successfully enabled strong encryption for data transmission, isolating critical industrial equipment with network segmentation (configured multi-path), enforcing strict access controls (MFA/VPN for remote access) by deploying NGFW and IDPS solutions, updating security baselines for hardware and software, and establishing centralized control and management of the entire offshore network.

09/2022 – 03/2023

IS Project Manager, College of American Pathologists (CAP) - (Remote/Contract W2 Role), Northfield, Illinois

Responsibilities:

- Led project planning, resource management, and vendor selection using Clarity Strategic Project Management (SPM), directed cross-functional teams in delivering high-quality Learning Management software solutions, and collaborated with the Change Advisory Board (CAB) to approve low-level design, scheduling, and cybersecurity strategies.

Projects & Achievements:

- **Successfully managed CAP's post-merger and acquisition (MA&D) remediation project:** Led SOC 2 compliance remediation by overseeing critical updates for 3,000+ systems, executing firmware and security patch implementations, decommissioning obsolete applications and equipment, and configuring security baselines, which collectively strengthened the organization's security framework and minimized vulnerabilities.
 - Spearheaded delivery of 95% of 100% SOC 2 compliant infrastructure.
 - Implemented system optimization measures post-divestiture that streamlined operations and reduced IT costs by 30%, while enhancing system performance and user experience for the remaining business units.
 - Contributed to developing a robust low-level design that includes contingency and backout plan, testing criteria, and creating batches on a per-site and application basis.
- **Spearheaded CAP's seamless transition from a legacy on-premises Learning Management System (LMS) to a cloud-based SaaS solution,** resulting in a 20% reduction in maintenance costs and a 15% increase in remote user training completion rates.

04/2016 – 04/2022

Senior ICT Manager at E-Marine PJSC (Etisalat - Emirates Telecommunication), Dubai, UAE

Responsibilities:

- Directed high-performance teams in Information & Operational Technologies onshore and offshore to ensure and support secure, efficient, and effective technology services across organizations, utilizing them throughout their lifecycle to help secure the organization's assets and data.
- **Oversaw the development and management of the infrastructure CAPEX and OPEX budget,** which involved forecasting, cost allocation, and expense monitoring. Recognized and executed cost-saving initiatives while maintaining quality standards.

- **Oversaw the daily operations of E-marine's IT infrastructure**, encompassing data centers, servers, network systems, storage, and cloud services, guaranteeing the best possible uptime, performance, and availability.

Projects & Achievements:

- **Successfully transformed the end-user computing environment** by executing cloud and Office 365 migrations, deploying Azure Virtual Desktop Infrastructure (VDI), and upgrading hardware, resulting in 97% remote user connectivity to corporate applications and a 30% increase in efficiency through automated disaster recovery.
- **Spearheaded seamless E-marine's Avaya telephony transition to Cisco Unified Communications Manager (CUCM) as part of Etisalat's mass rollout.** Executed all necessary modifications and new installations, integrating Cisco 8800 IP phones with Webex Calling across 18 regional branch locations, resulting in a 70% reduction in travel costs between HQ and regional branches. Enabled contact center module, enhanced offshore and onshore user experience, and achieved 15% decrease in IT support tickets related to telephony and contact center operations.
- **Deft in evaluating vendor products during a proof of concept (POC) for main warehouse Real-Time Location System (RTLS),** using AI-enabled Juniper MIST Wi-Fi and Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE) tracking to enhance efficiency and optimize workflows for a new warehouse building, based on RFP, RFI, and approved use cases.
- **Led the successful transition of E-marine's Service Desk to ServiceNow ITSM/PLM** by aligning with business objectives, engaging end-users for high adoption, and utilizing data analytics to enhance service delivery. Achieved significant improvements in Service Level Agreements (SLA) while effectively reducing Operational Level Agreement (OLA) breaches, ensuring ongoing success and elevated service performance.
- **Successfully led ISO/IEC 62443 comprehensive cybersecurity assessment program,** resulting in a 25% reduction in identified OT-related vulnerabilities and automation of control systems within the first year. This program involved assessing the onboard equipment of vessels, especially that related to operational technology (OT) and industrial control systems (ICS). Updated all industrial assets' (hardware, software, and network) inventory, defined and enforced role-based access controls, segmented the network to limit cyber threat spread, isolated critical industrial systems from business networks using VPN and SSH protocols, performed system hardening, restricted physical access to critical industrial equipment, and provided security awareness training for crew and technical staff.
- **Successfully led the migration from a legacy ERP system to a cloud-based SAP S/4HANA platform,** enhancing Financial and Procurement processes and Customer Relationship Management (CRM) systems. This initiative streamlined product lifecycle management, enhanced cross-functional collaboration, and expedited decision-making, resulting in increased operational efficiency and a substantial reduction in time-to-market for new implementation projects. This positioning enabled the organization to grow and scale in a rapidly changing market.
- **Achieved significant improvements in data center efficiency and productivity** by strategically implementing industry-leading security standards, including ISO/IEC 27001 and ISO 22301. Ensured full regulatory compliance by executing regular disaster recovery drills and testing, resulting in a 40% reduction in recovery time objectives (RTO) and a 50% reduction in recovery point objectives (RPO), exceeding industry standards.
- **Enhanced E-Marine's offshore incident response by implementing a comprehensive disaster recovery solution** in Microsoft Azure, utilizing Azure Site Recovery (DRaaS) along with other cloud-native services to ensure business continuity and reduce downtime for mission-critical applications.

10/2012 – 03/2016

Head of IT, Group of Companies | United Al Sager Group, BMW, Rolls-Royce | Abu Dhabi Motors, UAE

Responsibilities:

- **Spearheaded the development and execution of IT strategies** aligned with the business goals of multiple companies, fostering synergy and consolidation opportunities across the group.
- **Led and developed a high-performing team** of network engineers, systems administrators, functional managers, database administrators, project managers, and support staff, fostering a culture of continuous improvement, accountability, technical excellence, and precise performance expectations. This resulted in a 25% increase in overall productivity and team cohesion.
- **Crafted and implemented a strategic roadmap for Abu Dhabi Motors' IT infrastructure, aligning it with its modernization strategy.** This initiative led to an annual reduction of \$580,000 in licensing costs, introduced a shared

services model, and lowered operational expenses by outsourcing non-critical IT services to managed service providers.

- **Established and enforced IT policies, procedures, and standards** across the group to maintain consistency, compliance, and operational excellence. Ensured adherence to regulatory requirements, laws, and internal policies across all company IT operations and processes, minimizing legal and financial exposure.

Projects & Achievements:

- **Oversaw the implementation of a comprehensive IT Governance framework**, resulting in a nearly 60% reduction in cybersecurity incidents, by developing and executing a strategy that combined the COBIT IT governance model with the ISO/IEC 27001 information security framework.
 - Spearheaded the development and execution of policies, procedures, and guidelines in alignment with ISO 27001 standards and SOC2 compliance, ensuring strict adherence and enhancing organizational integrity.
 - Successfully tailored Policy & Compliance, Risk, and Audit Management workflows to enhance customer data security and expedite regulatory adherence, resulting in a 35% reduction in SOC2 audit preparation time.
- **Spearheaded \$20 million Digital Transformation Program for the United Al Saqr Group of Companies**, developing and executing a comprehensive IT infrastructure modernization strategy that resulted in an annual reduction of operational costs by \$1.2 million. The Scope of Work included Cloud Migration to Azure, data center consolidation for six organizations using Shared-Services model, revamping retail outlets' sales transition, e-commerce, and reporting to the **SAP Business One solution** to deliver enhanced customer experience.
- **Awarded 30% increment on Merger & Acquisition (M&A) project** - translating business strategy and objectives into "operating model," revamped six IT organizations into shared-service model, achieved business agility through consolidating/integrating IT functions including service desk, IT Infrastructure, and application support for six companies, including telephony services, O365, Websites, etc., into a dedicated shared services center.

07/2006 – 10/2012

Senior Manager, IT Infrastructure & Data Center Operations, Lloyds Banking Group, UK/UAE

Projects & Achievements:

- **Spearheaded transformation of Lloyds Bank Dubai's central Data Center**, earning recognition from the Group IT Director for 98.99% guaranteed availability and receiving team accolades for maintaining excellent cross-departmental communication and collaboration. Improved System Availability from 72.995% to 98.995% uptime by conducting periodic Business Continuity/Disaster Recovery (BCP/DR) tests for Business Impact Assessments (BIA) within two years.
- **Spearheaded the planning and execution of a brand-new Disaster Recovery (DR) Data Center buildout**, ensuring business continuity and minimizing potential downtime.
- **Directed the IT infrastructure divestiture project for Lloyds Bank**, successfully executing the separation of non-core technology assets and legacy systems. Implemented robust strategies that resulted in a 20% reduction in operational IT costs, while ensuring compliance and data integrity throughout the transition. Collaborated effectively with cross-functional teams to enhance service delivery, allowing the bank to focus on strategic growth initiatives and improve overall business agility
- **Received quarterly Lloyds Top Performer and Team of Year awards in 2008 & 2009**, respectively, for excellent performance in delivery of 100% compliance payment systems with ISO/IEC 27001, SOC, and PCI compliance

10/2004 – 06/2006

Project Manager, IT Infrastructure, Future Pipe Industries, Dubai, UAE

01/2000 – 06/2004

Systems Engineer, Amdahl/Fujitsu Computer Systems Tier-IV Data Center, Sunnyvale, California, USA

Software & Collaboration Tools: Microsoft Dynamics 365, Office 365, Microsoft 365, SharePoint, SAP Solution Manager, Smartsheet, Planview, Azure DevOps Server (TFS), Jira Kanban Board, Microsoft Project Professional, Confluence, Microsoft Visio, Power BI, ServiceNow ITSM, PPM, Clarity PPM, Microsoft Teams.